

The Roadmap Reveal

Presenting the plan to the client

Kurosawa Digital, executive boardroom. The projector hums. Ren's slides are loaded — revised three times since last night's rehearsal. Saki stands beside him with a clicker in one hand and a printed backup deck in the other. Director Kudo and four senior leaders sit across the table.

Ren (蓮) "Good morning. What you're about to see is the full roadmap for the XR platform — every **phase**, every **milestone**, and how we get from here to a working product by Week 24."

→ Ren frames the presentation around the *project lifecycle* — giving executives a clear structure they can follow without needing technical depth.

Saki (咲希) "The roadmap is anchored to our approved **scope baseline**. Each phase has defined **deliverables**, and we've mapped the **critical path** to show which activities determine our launch date."

→ Saki grounds the roadmap in formal PM artifacts — *scope baseline*, *deliverables*, and *critical path* — connecting the presentation to documented plans rather than promises.

Director Kudo (工藤部長) "Impressive structure. But let's be strategic — what does the board care about? The demo at Week 12. Tell me that's solid."

Ren (蓮) "The demo milestone sits on the **critical path**. Zero **float**. If any of the three activities leading into it slip, the demo slips. We've built buffer into the two weeks before it, but we're not hiding behind it."

→ Ren uses *schedule management* language naturally — critical path, float, buffer — to communicate risk honestly rather than overpromising.

Saki (咲希) "We've also identified resource constraints. The **network diagram** shows four activities dependent on a single team member. We have a cross-training plan to mitigate that."

→ Saki references the *network diagram* without showing it in detail — appropriate for an executive audience that needs confidence, not complexity.

Director Kudo (工藤部長) "I trust the team to manage the details. What I want to hear is: are we on track, and what do you need from us?"

Ren (蓮) "We need sign-off on the **scope statement** by Friday, and a decision on the AR module **requirements** Director Kudo raised last month. Those two items are blocking the planning phase exit."

→ Ren converts the presentation into specific asks — tying executive decisions to concrete project gates. This is effective *stakeholder* communication: making the audience's role in success clear.

Saki (咲希) *[quietly, as the executives confer]* "Your timing on the buffer slide was perfect. Told you the pause would work."

Ren (蓮) *[equally quiet]* "Your script notes saved me. I would've rambled through the cost section."

They share the smallest nod. Director Kudo watches them from across the table with an expression nobody can quite read.

Director Kudo (工藤部長) "You'll have your sign-off by Thursday. And I'll make a decision on the AR module by end of week. Good presentation. Both of you."

Concept Discovery — Synthesizing the Foundations

- 1 The Roadmap as Integration.** When Ren and Saki presented the roadmap, they were synthesizing concepts from across the project's foundations: the *project lifecycle* (Unit 1) provided the phase structure, *scope definition* (Unit 6) supplied the boundaries and deliverables, and *schedule management* (Unit 9) contributed the critical path and float analysis. A roadmap is not a new artifact — it's the story that ties existing PM documents together for an audience that needs the big picture, not the details. The most effective presentations translate technical PM data into decisions the audience can make.

Tip Tailor depth to your audience. Executives need milestones and decisions. Technical leads need dependencies and constraints. Match the level of detail to what the listener can act on.

- 2 Two PMs, One Message.** Ren and Saki's joint presentation worked because they divided the content by strength: Ren handled the narrative and stakeholder asks (intuitive, relational), while Saki anchored each claim to documented baselines (structured, evidence-based). This mirrors how effective PM pairs operate — different styles serving the same objective. Their rehearsal the night before was the real work; the presentation was just the delivery.

Phoenix Project Connection In *The Phoenix Project*, presenting a unified plan to leadership is the moment when IT earns a seat at the strategy table. The plan must speak in business outcomes, not technical activities.